

burnt onto CDs. For the free edition, support is available in the form of mailing lists and forums.

You can download Mandriva from wwwnew.mandriva.com/en/downloads/mirrors

8.1.3 SuSE

One of the earliest of the Linux flavours, and seen as a competitor to Red Hat, SuSE (pronounced Soo-Zay) is almost as old as the Linux kernel itself. SuSE is actually a German acronym written as S.u.S.E., and is short for “Software und System Entwicklung,” which means “Software and System Development.” SuSE Linux is currently being supported by Novell. Like Red Hat’s Linux, SuSE, too, is available separately for enterprise users, backed by assured support, and for personal use (enthusiast and developer) with newer features and limited support.



The latest and free version of SuSE is called *SuSE Linux*, while the enterprise versions are available as *SuSE Linux Enterprise Server*, *Novell Open Enterprise Server*, and *Novell Linux Desktop*.

OpenSUSE is a complete open source package of SuSE Linux that does not include any proprietary software such as Acrobat Reader, Macromedia Flash Player, etc. Currently, OpenSUSE 10.1 beta is available for download. For those of you who don’t want to mess around with a beta release, there is always the stable release 10 available for download. Unlike SuSE Linux, OpenSUSE does not come in Live CD form.

SuSE 10 uses its YaST installer, another easy-to-use installation tool. YaST allows you to create a partition for Linux using free space from the Windows partitions. Meaning, there is no need to have in place unformatted / free space or empty partition. A typical install would consume 2.5 GB, while the minimalist install with either KDE or GNOME will take some 700 MB. The versions of the desktops are 3.4.2 for KDE and 2.12 for GNOME.